



Colorful plumage

Like other species of macaw, this parrot has bright colors—blue above and yellow below—but it is surprisingly difficult to spot it when foraging high in the forest canopy.

Long tail

As well as their large size, reaching up to 34 in (86 cm) in length, macaws are also distinguished from other parrots by their long, tapering tail.

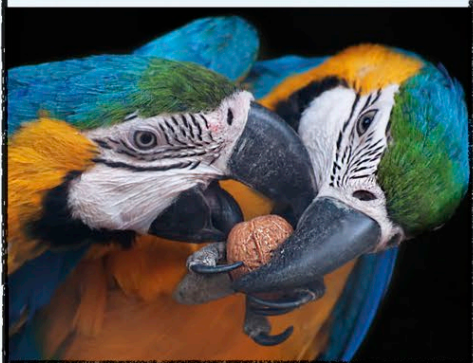
Amazonian parrot

The blue-and-yellow macaw is found throughout the Amazon forest. Here, tall trees provide fruit and nuts for feeding, while the trunks of dead palms offer comfortable holes to nest.

This parrot is still common throughout much of the region, but it is becoming threatened by deforestation and the pet trade.

Tools for dining

Like all parrots, the blue-and-yellow macaw is equipped to pick up and crack open hard-shelled nuts. It uses its clawed feet and a very powerful, but sensitive, beak to grasp and break open nuts. Sometimes, one macaw may try to steal the seed from another.



Blue-and-yellow macaw

This spectacular bird is one of the biggest of the world's 405 parrot species. The blue-and-yellow macaw flies in noisy flocks over the canopy of the world's largest forest, the Amazon, which covers much of northern South America.